K A M P A L A · T R A F F I C B R I E F

Kampala traffic in three facts

What congestion costs the city, from three published studies. Each figure is quoted from its source and carries that source's date.

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1. Congestion costs about USD 1.5 million a working day.

That is 4.2 per cent of Greater Kampala's daily GDP and 1.9 per cent of Uganda's. Total travel time in the metro area is valued at USD 5.1 million a day, 13.7 per cent of local GDP.

Source: IGC policy brief UGA-19148, August 2020, built on the 2016/17 KCCA travel habit survey.

2. A commuter loses 8 to 23 hours a month, and speeds halve.

Free-flow travel in Kampala averages about 28 km/h. In jams it falls to between 8 and 14 km/h. The loss of productive time is put at UGX 55–163 billion a year. Findings from a survey of 291 road users.

Source: Uganda Management Institute, 'Causes and cost of traffic jams in Kampala'.

3. The peak windows are 5:30–9:00 AM and 4:00–9:00 PM.

A trip into or out of the city inside those windows takes between 1 and 5 hours. Average vehicle speed across the Greater Kampala Metropolitan Area is 25.9 km/h. Roads carry 90 per cent of the city's transport.

Source: KCCA, Entambulayo News Bite, Volume 2.

These are study figures at their stated dates, not live measurements. Conditions in the city have changed since, most of them for the worse. Prepared 18 October 2026.